

考研英语学习报告：梦的本质与可控性

一、文章主旨

英文主旨

This passage explores the nature, function, and controllability of dreams, arguing that dreams are emotional regulators of the mind, can be consciously controlled, and help people process negative emotions and improve mood.

中文主旨

本文探讨了梦的本质、功能与可控性，提出梦是大脑的情绪调节器，可被有意识地控制，帮助人们处理负面情绪、改善心境。

二、逐句精读（翻译+核心词汇+长难句分析）

第一段

1. **原文**: Of all the components of a good night's sleep, dreams seem to be least within our control.

翻译: 在一夜好眠的所有组成部分中，梦似乎是最不受我们控制的。

核心词汇/短语:

- component n. 组成部分; 成分
- within one's control 受某人控制
- least adv. 最少; 最不

2. **原文**: In dreams, a window opens into a world where logic is suspended and dead people speak.

翻译: 在梦中，一扇窗户通向了一个逻辑暂时失效、逝者开口说话的世界。

核心词汇/短语:

- suspend v. 暂停; 中止; 悬浮
- logic n. 逻辑; 逻辑学

3. **原文**: A century ago, Freud formulated his revolutionary theory that dreams were the disguised shadows of our unconscious desires and fears;

翻译: 一个世纪前，弗洛伊德提出了他具有革命性的理论：梦是我们潜意识欲望与恐惧的伪装投射。

核心词汇/短语:

- formulate v. 制定; 构想; 系统阐述
- revolutionary adj. 革命性的; n. 革命者
- disguised adj. 伪装的; 掩饰的
- unconscious adj. 无意识的; 潜意识的
- desire n. 欲望; v. 渴望
- fear n. 恐惧; v. 害怕

长难句分析: that引导同位语从句，解释说明theory的具体内容；分号连接两个并列分句，实现语义转折。

4. **原文**: by the late 1970s, neurologists had switched to thinking of them as just “mental noise” — the random byproducts of the neural-repair work that goes on during sleep.

翻译: 到20世纪70年代末, 神经学家们转而将梦仅仅视为“精神噪音”——睡眠期间大脑神经修复工作产生的随机副产品。

核心词汇/短语:

- neurologist n. 神经学家
- switch to 转向; 转而
- think of A as B 把A看作B
- random adj. 随机的; 随意的
- byproduct n. 副产品
- neural-repair 神经修复

长难句分析: 破折号后为同位语, 对“mental noise”进行解释说明; that引导定语从句, 修饰先行词neural-repair work。

5. **原文**: Now researchers suspect that dreams are part of the mind’s emotional thermostat, regulating moods while the brain is “off-line.”

翻译: 如今, 研究人员认为, 梦是大脑情绪恒温器的一部分, 在大脑“离线”(休息)时调节情绪。

核心词汇/短语:

- suspect v. 怀疑; 猜想; 认为
- emotional thermostat 情绪恒温器
- regulate v. 调节; 控制
- mood n. 情绪; 心情
- off-line 离线的; 不工作的

长难句分析: that引导宾语从句, 作suspect的宾语; regulating moods为现在分词作伴随状语; while引导时间状语从句, 说明动作发生的背景。

6. **原文**: And one leading authority says that these intensely powerful mental events can be not only harnessed but actually brought under conscious control, to help us sleep and feel better.

翻译: 一位权威专家表示, 这些极具影响力的心理活动不仅可以被驾驭, 甚至可以被有意识地控制, 从而帮助我们改善睡眠、提升心情。

核心词汇/短语:

- leading authority 权威人士; 权威专家
- intensely adv. 强烈地; 极度地
- harness v. 利用; 驾驭; 控制
- bring under control 控制住
- conscious adj. 有意识的; 自觉的

长难句分析: that引导宾语从句, 作says的宾语; 宾语从句中使用not only...but (also)...结构, 连接两个被动语态的谓语 (can be harnessed, (can be) brought); to help...为不定式作目的状语, 说明控制梦的作用。

7. **原文**: “It’s your dream,” says Rosalind Cartwright, chair of psychology at Chicago’s Medical Center. “If you don’t like it, change it.”

翻译: “梦是你自己的,” 芝加哥医学中心心理学系主任罗莎琳德·卡特赖特说, “如果你不喜欢它, 就改变它。”

核心词汇/短语:

- chair n. 主席; 系主任; v. 主持
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第二段

1. **原文:** Evidence from brain imaging supports this view.

翻译: 来自大脑成像的证据支持了这一观点。

核心词汇/短语:

- evidence n. 证据; 证明
- brain imaging 大脑成像
- support v. 支持; 证实
- view n. 观点; 看法

2. **原文:** The brain is as active during REM (rapid eye movement) sleep — when most vivid dreams occur — as it is when fully awake, says Dr. Eric Nofzinger at the University of Pittsburgh.

翻译: 匹兹堡大学的埃里克·诺夫辛格博士表示, 在快速眼动 (REM) 睡眠期 (大多数鲜活生动的梦都发生在这个阶段), 大脑的活跃程度与完全清醒时无异。

核心词汇/短语:

- REM (rapid eye movement) sleep 快速眼动睡眠
- vivid adj. 生动的; 鲜活的
- occur v. 发生; 出现
- as...as... 和.....一样.....

长难句分析: 本句为倒装句, 正常语序为 Dr. Eric Nofzinger... says (that) the brain is as active during REM sleep... as it is when fully awake; 两个破折号之间是when引导的定语从句, 修饰REM sleep; 第二个as后为比较状语从句, it指代the brain, when fully awake为省略了主语和系动词的时间状语从句 (完整形式: when it is fully awake) 。

3. **原文:** But not all parts of the brain are equally involved; the limbic system (the “emotional brain”) is especially active, while the prefrontal cortex (the center of intellect and reasoning) is relatively quiet.

翻译: 但并非大脑的所有区域都同等参与其中: 边缘系统 (“情绪脑”) 异常活跃, 而前额叶皮层 (智力与推理中枢) 则相对平静。

核心词汇/短语:

- equally adv. 同等地; 同样地
- involved adj. 参与的; 有关的
- limbic system 边缘系统
- prefrontal cortex 前额叶皮层
- intellect n. 智力; 理解力
- reasoning n. 推理; 论证
- relatively adv. 相对地; 比较地

长难句分析: 分号连接两个并列分句; 第二个分句中while表示对比, 连接两个结构对称的句子, 突出不同脑区的活跃差异。

4. **原文:** “We wake up from dreams happy or depressed, and those feelings can stay with us all day.” says Stanford sleep researcher Dr. William Dement.

翻译: “我们从梦中醒来时, 或开心或沮丧, 这些情绪会伴随我们一整天。”斯坦福大学睡眠研究员威廉·德门特博士说。

核心词汇/短语:

- depressed adj. 沮丧的; 抑郁的
 - stay with sb. 伴随某人; 留在某人身边
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第三段

1. **原文:** The link between dreams and emotions shows up among the patients in Cartwright's clinic.

翻译: 梦与情绪之间的关联在卡特赖特诊所的患者身上有所体现。

核心词汇/短语:

- link n. 联系; 关联; v. 连接
- show up 显现; 出现
- clinic n. 诊所; 门诊部

2. **原文:** Most people seem to have more bad dreams early in the night, progressing toward happier ones before awakening, suggesting that they are working through negative feelings generated during the day.

翻译: 大多数人似乎在夜间早些时候会做更多噩梦, 在醒来前逐渐转向更愉快的梦, 这表明他们正在消解白天产生的负面情绪。

核心词汇/短语:

- progress toward 向.....进展; 逐渐走向
- awakening n. 醒来; 觉醒
- work through 解决; 消解; 克服
- negative adj. 负面的; 消极的
- generate v. 产生; 引起

长难句分析: 句子主干为 Most people seem to have more bad dreams...;

progressing toward... 为现在分词作伴随状语, 说明梦的变化趋势; suggesting

that... 为现在分词作结果状语, that引导宾语从句, 说明现象背后的原理; generated during the day 为过去分词作后置定语, 修饰negative feelings。

3. **原文:** Because our conscious mind is occupied with daily life we don't always think about the emotional significance of the day's events — until, it appears, we begin to dream.

翻译: 由于我们的意识被日常生活占据, 我们并不会总去思考白天发生的事所蕴含的情绪意义——直到我们开始做梦, 情况似乎才有所改变。

核心词汇/短语:

- conscious mind 意识
- be occupied with 忙于; 被.....占据
- significance n. 意义; 重要性
- event n. 事件; 发生的事
- until 直到.....为止

长难句分析: because引导原因状语从句, 主句为 we don't always think about...; 破折号后until引导时间状语从句, it appears 为插入语, 补充说明语气。

第四段

1. **原文:** And this process need not be left to the unconscious.

翻译: 而且这一过程不必完全交由潜意识掌控。

核心词汇/短语:

- leave A to B 把A交由B处理
- unconscious n. 潜意识; 无意识

2. **原文:** Cartwright believes one can exercise conscious control over recurring bad dreams.

翻译: 卡特赖特认为, 人们可以有意识地控制反复出现的噩梦。

核心词汇/短语:

- exercise control over 对.....实施控制
- recurring adj. 反复出现的; recurring bad dreams 反复出现的噩梦

3. **原文**: As soon as you awaken, identify what is upsetting about the dream.

翻译: 你一醒来, 就明确梦中让你困扰的内容。

核心词汇/短语:

- as soon as 一.....就.....
- identify v. 识别; 明确
- upsetting adj. 令人苦恼的; 令人不安的

4. **原文**: Visualize how you would like it to end instead; the next time it occurs, try to wake up just enough to control its course.

翻译: 在脑海中设想你希望梦如何结束; 下次它再出现时, 试着刚好醒来, 以此掌控梦的走向。

核心词汇/短语:

- visualize v. 想象; 设想
- instead 代替; 而不是
- occur v. 发生; 出现
- course n. 进程; 走向; 过程

长难句分析: 分号连接两个并列分句; 第一个分句中how引导宾语从句, 作visualize的宾语; 第二个分句中 the next time 引导时间状语从句, 相当于when。

5. **原文**: With much practice people can learn to, literally, do it in their sleep.

翻译: 通过大量练习, 人们确实可以学会在睡梦中做到这一点。

核心词汇/短语:

- literally adv. 确实地; 字面上地; 真正地

第五段

1. **原文**: At the end of the day, there's probably little reason to pay attention to our dreams at all unless they keep us from sleeping or "we wake up in a panic," Cartwright says.

翻译: 卡特赖特认为, 说到底, 除非梦让我们无法入睡, 或是“我们在恐慌中醒来”, 否则我们几乎没有理由去关注梦。

核心词汇/短语:

- at the end of the day 说到底; 终究
- keep sb. from doing sth. 阻止某人做某事
- panic n. 恐慌; 惊慌

长难句分析: 句子主干为 there's little reason to pay attention to our dreams...; unless引导条件状语从句, 包含两个并列的分句 (they keep us from sleeping / we wake up in a panic); Cartwright says 为插入语, 点明观点来源。

2. **原文**: Terrorism, economic uncertainties and general feelings of insecurity have increased people's anxiety.

翻译: 恐怖主义、经济不确定性以及普遍的不安全感加剧了人们的焦虑。

核心词汇/短语:

- terrorism n. 恐怖主义
- uncertainty n. 不确定性
- insecurity n. 不安全感
- anxiety n. 焦虑; 忧虑

3. **原文**: Those suffering from persistent nightmares should seek help from a therapist.

翻译: 那些长期受噩梦困扰的人应该寻求治疗师的帮助。

核心词汇/短语:

- suffer from 遭受; 受.....困扰
- persistent adj. 持续的; 长期的
- nightmare n. 噩梦
- seek help from 向.....寻求帮助

- therapist n. 治疗师; 理疗师

4. **原文:** For the rest of us, the brain has its ways of working through bad feelings.

翻译: 对于其他人而言, 大脑自有消解负面情绪的方法。

核心词汇/短语:

- for the rest of us 对于我们其他人而言
- work through 解决; 消解

5. **原文:** Sleep — or rather dream — on it and you'll feel better in the morning.

翻译: 睡一觉——更确切地说, 做个梦——就好了, 早上醒来你会感觉好多了。

核心词汇/短语:

- or rather 更确切地说; 说的更准确些

三、完整原文与全文翻译

完整原文

Of all the components of a good night's sleep, dreams seem to be least within our control. In dreams, a window opens into a world where logic is suspended and dead people speak. A century ago, Freud formulated his revolutionary theory that dreams were the disguised shadows of our unconscious desires and fears; by the late 1970s, neurologists had switched to thinking of them as just "mental noise" — the random byproducts of the neural-repair work that goes on during sleep. Now researchers suspect that dreams are part of the mind's emotional thermostat, regulating moods while the brain is "off-line." And one leading authority says that these intensely powerful mental events can be not only harnessed but actually brought under conscious control, to help us sleep and feel better. "It's your dream," says Rosalind Cartwright, chair of psychology at Chicago's Medical Center. "If you don't like it, change it."

Evidence from brain imaging supports this view. The brain is as active during REM (rapid eye movement) sleep — when most vivid dreams occur — as it is when fully awake, says Dr. Eric Nofzinger at the University of Pittsburgh. But not all parts of the brain are equally involved; the limbic system (the "emotional brain") is especially active, while the prefrontal cortex (the center of intellect and reasoning) is relatively quiet. "We wake up from dreams happy or depressed, and those feelings can stay with us all day," says Stanford sleep researcher Dr. William Dement.

The link between dreams and emotions shows up among the patients in Cartwright's clinic. Most people seem to have more bad dreams early in the night, progressing toward happier ones before awakening, suggesting that they are working through negative feelings generated during the day. Because our conscious mind is occupied with daily life we don't always think about the emotional significance of the day's events — until, it appears, we begin to dream.

And this process need not be left to the unconscious. Cartwright believes one can exercise conscious control over recurring bad dreams. As soon as you awaken, identify what is upsetting about the dream. Visualize how you would like it to end instead; the next time it occurs, try to wake up just enough to control its course. With much practice people can learn to, literally, do it in their sleep.

At the end of the day, there's probably little reason to pay attention to our dreams at all unless they keep us from sleeping or "we wake up in a panic," Cartwright says. Terrorism, economic uncertainties and general feelings of insecurity have increased people's anxiety. Those suffering from persistent nightmares should seek help from a therapist. For the rest of us, the brain has its ways of working through bad feelings. Sleep — or rather dream — on it and you'll feel better in the morning.

全文翻译

在一夜好眠的所有组成部分中，梦似乎是最不受我们控制的。在梦中，一扇窗户通向了一个逻辑暂时失效、逝者开口说话的世界。一个世纪前，弗洛伊德提出了他具有革命性的理论：梦是我们潜意识欲望与恐惧的伪装投射；到20世纪70年代末，神经学家们转而将梦仅仅视为“精神噪音”——睡眠期间大脑神经修复工作产生的随机副产品。如今，研究人员认为，梦是大脑情绪恒温器的一部分，在大脑“离线”（休息）时调节情绪。一位权威专家表示，这些极具影响力的心理活动不仅可以被驾驭，甚至可以被有意识地控制，从而帮助我们改善睡眠、提升心情。“梦是你自己的，”芝加哥医学中心心理学系主任罗莎琳德·卡特赖特说，“如果你不喜欢它，就改变它。”

来自大脑成像的证据支持了这一观点。匹兹堡大学的埃里克·诺夫辛格博士表示，在快速眼动（REM）睡眠期（大多数鲜活生动的梦都发生在这个阶段），大脑的活跃程度与完全清醒时无异。但并非大脑的所有区域都同等参与其中：边缘系统（“情绪脑”）异常活跃，而前额叶皮层（智力与推理中枢）则相对平静。“我们从梦中醒来时，或开心或沮丧，这些情绪会伴随我们一整天。”斯坦福大学睡眠研究员威廉·德门特博士说。

梦与情绪之间的关联在卡特赖特诊所的患者身上有所体现。大多数人似乎在夜间早些时候会做更多噩梦，在醒来前逐渐转向更愉快的梦，这表明他们正在消解白天产生的负面情绪。由于我们的意识被日常生活占据，我们并不会总去思考白天发生的事所蕴含的情绪意义——直到我们开始做梦，情况似乎才有所改变。

而且这一过程不必完全交由潜意识掌控。卡特赖特认为，人们可以有意识地控制反复出现的噩梦。你一醒来，就明确梦中让你困扰的内容。在脑海中设想你希望梦如何结束；下次它再出现时，试着刚好醒来，以此掌控梦的走向。通过大量练习，人们确实可以学会在睡梦中做到这一点。

卡特赖特认为，说到底，除非梦让我们无法入睡，或是“我们在恐慌中醒来”，否则我们几乎没有理由去关注梦。恐怖主义、经济不确定性以及普遍的不安全感加剧了人们的焦虑。那些长期受噩梦困扰的人应该寻求治疗师的帮助。对于其他人而言，大脑自有消解负面情绪的方法。睡一觉——更确切地说，做个梦——就好了，早上醒来你会感觉好多了。